

React Native (Expo) – Complete Environment Setup Guide

This guide provides a full step-by-step installation and setup for developing React Native applications using Expo.

Follow the steps in order.

Step 1: Install Node.js (Required)

Node.js is required to run JavaScript, npm, Expo CLI, and React Native tools.

1. Go to the official Node.js website: <https://nodejs.org/en>
2. Download and install Node.js v24.12.0 (LTS) or the latest available LTS
3. Use default installation settings
4. Restart your terminal after installation

Verify installation:

```
node -v  
npm -v
```

Step 2: Update npm OR Install Yarn

Option A (Recommended): Update npm

```
npm install -g npm@latest
```

Verify:

```
npm -v
```

Option B (Optional): Install Yarn

```
npm install --global yarn
```

Verify:

```
yarn -v
```

Important: Use either npm or yarn, not both, in the same project.

Step 3: Install Visual Studio Code (Required)

1. Download from: <https://code.visualstudio.com/>
2. Install using default options

Recommended Extensions:

- ESLint
 - Prettier
 - ES7+ React Snippets (optional)
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Step 4: Install Git (Required)

1. Download from: <https://git-scm.com/install>
2. Install using default settings

Verify:

```
git --version
```

Step 5: Install Expo CLI (Required)

Expo CLI is used to create and run React Native apps.

Recommended method (no global install):

```
npx expo --version
```

Step 6: Install Expo Go (Android or iOS)

Expo Go is a sandbox app for quick mobile prototyping. Install it on your device to test your Expo apps.

For Android:

1. Visit: <https://expo.dev/go>
2. Click on "Android Install" or scan the QR code
3. Alternatively, search for "Expo Go" in the Google Play Store
4. Install the app on your Android device

For iOS:

1. Visit: <https://expo.dev/go>
2. Click on "iOS Install" or scan the QR code
3. Alternatively, search for "Expo Go" in the App Store
4. Install the app on your iOS device

Note: Make sure your device and computer are on the same Wi-Fi network when running Expo apps.

Step 7: Install Android Emulator (Optional)

Note: This step is optional. You can use Expo Go on a physical device instead. However, having an Android emulator is useful for testing without a physical device.

For detailed installation instructions, refer to: <https://reactnative.dev/docs/set-up-your-environment>

Usage: Once set up, you can use the Android emulator with Expo by pressing **a** when running **npx expo start**.

Next Steps: See [creating first app.md](#) for instructions on creating and running your first Expo app.

Optional Accounts

- GitHub account: <https://github.com>
 - Expo account (recommended): <https://expo.dev>
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Final Verification

```
node -v
npm -v
git --version
npx expo --version
```

You are ready to create your first Expo app! Proceed to [creating first app.md](#) for the next steps.